

QUESTION 1

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Historian David Owusu has argued that the rapid expansion of railway networks in nineteenth-century West Africa primarily served the economic interests of colonial powers, enabling the efficient extraction of natural resources such as cocoa and minerals for export to European markets.

Text 2

While acknowledging the exploitative origins of West African railways, economic geographer Fatima Diallo contends that these networks also facilitated the growth of internal trade among West African communities. Market towns along rail corridors experienced population growth and economic diversification that persisted long after independence.

Based on the texts, how would Diallo (Text 2) most likely respond to Owusu's characterization of West African railways in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that Owusu is mistaken about railways enabling resource extraction, since most colonial exports traveled by river routes rather than rail.
- B: By contending that the economic interests of colonial powers and the interests of local communities were identical, making Owusu's criticism of colonial motives misdirected.
- C: By arguing that Owusu has overlooked the railways' lasting benefits for local West African economies.
- D: By proposing that railways weakened internal trade by diverting goods toward export markets, making Owusu's account incomplete for a different reason.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Diallo says "While acknowledging" -- she concedes Owusu's point about colonial exploitation, then adds that he missed the internal trade benefits. Trick: "While acknowledging" or "While conceding" = agree with part + add what was overlooked. That's "overlooked," not "contradicted."

END QUESTION

QUESTION 2

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Psychologist Leon Whitfield argues that handwriting instruction remains essential in elementary education. Studies show that the motor act of forming letters by hand activates brain regions associated with reading comprehension and memory retention in ways that typing does not.

Text 2

Education researcher Mei-Lin Zhao points out that digital literacy skills are increasingly prerequisite for academic and professional success. Given limited instructional time, Zhao argues, schools should prioritize keyboarding proficiency over extensive handwriting practice, since students will spend the vast majority of their academic and professional lives composing text on screens.

Based on the texts, the authors of Text 1 and Text 2 would most likely disagree about which of the following?

- A: Whether handwriting instruction or keyboarding instruction should receive more emphasis in elementary school curricula.
- B: Whether studies on motor activity and cognition are methodologically sound.
- C: Whether elementary schools currently allocate sufficient total time to language arts instruction.
- D: Whether digital literacy has any relevance to students' long-term academic success.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Whitfield says handwriting is essential; Zhao says prioritize keyboarding. One says X, the other says not-X.

Trick: for "disagree about" questions, find the specific claim where the authors take opposite sides. Silence on a topic (Whitfield never mentions digital literacy) is not disagreement about it.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 3

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Botanist Julia Tran has documented that urban gardens in temperate climates support a surprising diversity of native bee species. Her surveys of 60 community gardens across three cities found an average of 24 native bee species per site, suggesting that small green spaces can serve as meaningful pollinator refuges.

Text 2

Entomologist Ravi Subramanian cautions that species counts alone may overstate the ecological value of urban gardens. Many of the native bee species found in these settings are habitat generalists -- species that thrive in many environments -- while the specialist species most at risk of decline are largely absent from urban gardens.

Based on the texts, how would Subramanian (Text 2) most likely respond to Tran's conclusion about urban gardens in Text 1?

- A: By noting that Tran's survey methodology likely undercounted the actual number of bee species present in each garden.
- B: By claiming that community gardens are too small in total area to support any ecologically meaningful population of native bees.
- C: By arguing that the bee species Tran documented are primarily non-native species that compete with and displace native pollinators.
- D: By suggesting that Tran's species counts may not reflect the gardens' value for the bee species most in need of conservation.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Subramanian doesn't say the counts are wrong -- he says they're misleading because they include generalists, not the at-risk specialists. Trick: "species counts alone may overstate" = the metric is valid but the interpretation is too optimistic. That's a critique of what the data MEAN, not how they were collected.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 4

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Archaeologists have long believed that the earliest inhabitants of the Canary Islands arrived from the North African mainland by sea around 100 BCE. This timeline is based on radiocarbon dating of organic materials recovered from the oldest known settlement sites.

Text 2

Genetic analyses of modern Canary Islanders indicate that the founding population's closest genetic relatives are the Amazigh peoples of northwestern Africa. Molecular clock estimates based on these genetic data suggest that the migration to the Canary Islands may have occurred as early as 500 BCE, several centuries before the date suggested by the archaeological record alone.

Based on the texts, what is the relationship between the archaeological evidence discussed in Text 1 and the genetic evidence discussed in Text 2?

A: The genetic evidence contradicts the archaeological evidence by identifying a different geographic origin for the first settlers of the Canary Islands.

B: The genetic evidence suggests an earlier date of migration than the archaeological evidence does.

C: The genetic evidence confirms the archaeological timeline but identifies a previously unknown migration route from North Africa.

D: The archaeological evidence provides a narrower date range than the genetic evidence, which can only indicate that migration occurred sometime before 1000 BCE.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Both texts agree on North African origin -- the disagreement is purely about timing (100 BCE vs. 500 BCE).

Trick: read what the texts actually differ on. If both say "North Africa," geographic origin is shared ground. The difference is "when," not "where."

END QUESTION

QUESTION 5

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Political theorist Amara Osei contends that compulsory voting -- requiring all eligible citizens to cast ballots under penalty of a small fine -- would increase democratic legitimacy by ensuring that election outcomes reflect the preferences of the entire electorate rather than only those motivated enough to vote voluntarily.

Text 2

Philosopher Nikolai Petrov argues that compelling citizens to vote undermines the very freedom that democratic governance is meant to protect. In Petrov's view, the right to vote inherently includes the right not to vote, and penalizing abstention transforms a civic privilege into a coercive obligation.

Based on the texts, Osei and Petrov would most likely disagree about which of the following?

- A: Whether requiring citizens to vote would be a desirable policy for democratic societies.
- B: Whether the right to vote is a fundamental component of democratic governance.
- C: Whether voter turnout rates have any effect on the legitimacy of election outcomes.
- D: Whether small fines are an effective method of enforcing government policies in general.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Osei: compulsory voting increases legitimacy. Petrov: compulsory voting undermines freedom. Direct opposition on the same policy. Trick: both authors assume voting rights exist -- the dispute is about whether voting should be REQUIRED, not whether it should be ALLOWED.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 6

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Linguist Hannah Bergstrom has found that bilingual children who learn both languages from birth tend to develop strong proficiency in each language by age five, suggesting that simultaneous bilingual exposure does not impede language development.

Text 2

Developmental psychologist Carlos Rivera notes that bilingual children sometimes lag behind monolingual peers in vocabulary size within each individual language during the early years, even though their total vocabulary across both languages is comparable to that of monolingual children. Rivera emphasizes that this early lag is temporary and typically disappears by school age.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 would most likely agree with which statement about the temporary vocabulary lag described in Text 2?

- A: It has been documented only in studies with methodological flaws that make the findings unreliable.
- B: It is most likely the result of children receiving unequal exposure to the two languages at home rather than a feature of bilingualism itself.
- C: It does not indicate that bilingual exposure is ultimately harmful to children's language development.
- D: It provides strong evidence that monolingual children develop communication skills more efficiently than bilingual children do.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Text 1 says bilingual exposure "does not impede" development; Text 2 says the lag is "temporary and disappears." Both ultimately agree bilingualism isn't harmful. Trick: for "would most likely agree" questions, find the overlapping ground. Temporary != harmful, and both texts land on the same positive conclusion.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 7

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Astronomer Kenji Mori argues that the search for extraterrestrial intelligence (SETI) should focus on detecting laser-based optical signals rather than traditional radio waves. Laser signals, Mori notes, can carry far more information per second and are easier to distinguish from natural astrophysical phenomena.

Text 2

Astronomer Celeste Duval counters that radio-wave detection remains the most practical approach for SETI. Radio telescopes are widely available, relatively inexpensive to operate, and have already amassed decades of archived data that can be reanalyzed with improving algorithms.

Based on the texts, which statement best characterizes the relationship between Mori's position (Text 1) and Duval's position (Text 2)?

- A: They disagree about whether current technology is capable of detecting signals from extraterrestrial intelligence at all.
- B: Duval provides experimental data that disproves Mori's technical claims about the information-carrying capacity of laser signals.
- C: Both authors advocate for expanding SETI's scope to include optical signals but propose different timelines for implementation.
- D: They disagree about which signal type should be prioritized in the search for extraterrestrial intelligence.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Mori wants lasers (better information density); Duval wants radio (better practicality). Different priorities, same goal. Trick: Duval argues from practicality and infrastructure, not by disproving laser advantages. A practicality argument is not a technical refutation.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 8

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: EASY

PROMPT: Text 1

Economist Irene Walters has observed that nations with higher rates of broadband internet access tend to experience faster GDP growth, a correlation she attributes to the productivity gains that high-speed connectivity enables across multiple economic sectors.

Text 2

Development scholar Oumar Sy cautions that the relationship between broadband access and economic growth may be partly reverse-causal: wealthier nations can afford to invest more in internet infrastructure, so GDP growth may drive broadband expansion as much as broadband expansion drives GDP growth.

Based on the texts, how would Sy (Text 2) most likely respond to Walters's argument in Text 1?

- A: By suggesting that Walters has underestimated the financial cost of building broadband infrastructure in developing nations.
- B: By pointing out that Walters may have the direction of causation partly reversed.
- C: By arguing that GDP growth is driven exclusively by factors unrelated to internet connectivity.
- D: By claiming that broadband access has been shown to decrease economic productivity in certain sectors.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Walters says broadband -> GDP. Sy says maybe GDP -> broadband too. The arrow may point both ways.

Trick: "reverse-causal" doesn't mean "no effect." Sy says "partly" -- he's not denying broadband helps; he's saying the causal direction is more complicated than Walters claims.

END QUESTION



QUESTION 9

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Neuroscientist Adeline Park proposes that the brain's default mode network (DMN) -- a set of interconnected brain regions active during rest and mind-wandering -- plays a central role in creative ideation. Park points to neuroimaging studies showing that artists and writers exhibit heightened DMN activity during brainstorming tasks.

Text 2

Cognitive psychologist Tomas Ruiz argues that creativity cannot be attributed to any single neural network. In Ruiz's view, creative thought requires dynamic interplay between the DMN and the executive control network (ECN), which governs focused attention and evaluation. Without ECN involvement, Ruiz contends, the unconstrained associations generated by the DMN would rarely yield coherent or useful ideas.

Based on the texts, how would Ruiz (Text 2) most likely respond to Park's proposal in Text 1?

- A: By arguing that Park's model overemphasizes one neural network and neglects the contribution of another network that is essential for refining creative output.
- B: By presenting evidence that artists and writers do not actually exhibit higher DMN activity than other professionals during creative tasks.
- C: By claiming that the executive control network, rather than the default mode network, is solely responsible for all forms of creative thought.
- D: By disputing the reliability of the neuroimaging technology used in the studies that Park cites as evidence.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Ruiz doesn't deny the DMN is involved -- he says it's insufficient without the ECN. His critique is conceptual (model is incomplete), not methodological (imaging is unreliable). Trick: "cannot be attributed to any single network" = the model overemphasizes one and neglects another. Watch for responses that correctly identify the TYPE of criticism -- conceptual vs. methodological.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 10

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Historian Leila Abbas has argued that the decline of the Ottoman Empire in the nineteenth century was driven primarily by internal administrative dysfunction, including corruption, bureaucratic inertia, and the failure to modernize tax collection systems.

Text 2

Historian Marcus Brennan contends that internal factors alone cannot explain the Ottoman decline. Brennan emphasizes the role of external pressures -- particularly the economic penetration of European industrial powers, whose cheap manufactured goods flooded Ottoman markets and undermined local artisans -- in accelerating the empire's economic deterioration.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between Abbas's argument (Text 1) and Brennan's argument (Text 2)?

- A: Abbas provides a more comprehensive analysis of the Ottoman decline than Brennan, whose argument focuses narrowly on a single external factor.
- B: Brennan and Abbas identify the same set of causes but reach different conclusions about which cause was most damaging.
- C: Abbas and Brennan agree on both the causes and the timeline of the Ottoman decline but differ on the geographic scope of its effects.
- D: Brennan acknowledges the factors Abbas identifies but argues that additional factors were also significant.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: "Internal factors alone cannot explain" = I agree they matter, but they're not sufficient -- external factors were also significant. Trick: "alone cannot explain" is a concession + addition. Brennan doesn't reject Abbas's causes; he says they're incomplete. This is the same "acknowledge + add" pattern as Q1.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 11

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Literary critic Josephine Lam has observed that contemporary novels increasingly employ fragmented narrative structures -- multiple timelines, shifting perspectives, and nonlinear plotting -- to mirror the disjointed nature of modern digital experience.

Text 2

Novelist and essayist Raymond Udo argues that fragmented narrative structures predate the digital age by more than a century, pointing to works like Laurence Sterne's *Tristram Shandy* (1759). While Udo acknowledges that digital culture may have popularized such techniques among a wider readership, he maintains that attributing their rise to technology oversimplifies a complex literary tradition.

Based on the texts, how would Udo (Text 2) most likely respond to Lam's observation in Text 1?

- A: By agreeing that the increase in fragmented narrative structures in contemporary fiction can be attributed primarily to digital technology's influence on reading habits.
- B: By claiming that fragmented narrative structures are actually less prevalent in contemporary novels than they were in eighteenth- and nineteenth-century fiction.
- C: By arguing that Lam has overstated the role of digital culture in the development of fragmented narrative, given the technique's long literary history.
- D: By asserting that Lam has incorrectly defined what qualifies as a fragmented narrative structure, since works like *Tristram Shandy* use a fundamentally different technique.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Udo says "oversimplifies" -- he acknowledges digital culture "popularized" the techniques but insists the technique predates technology by centuries. Trick: "oversimplifies" = credits one factor too much. Udo doesn't deny digital culture's role entirely; he says it's overstated because the literary tradition is older and more complex.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 12

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Material scientist Akiko Tanaka has demonstrated that aerogels -- extremely lightweight, porous solid materials -- can be manufactured from recycled cellulose fibers, potentially offering an environmentally sustainable alternative to petroleum-based insulation products. Tanaka's cellulose aerogels achieved thermal conductivity values comparable to conventional foam insulation.

Text 2

Engineer Dmitri Volkov notes that while cellulose-based aerogels show promise in laboratory settings, their mechanical fragility poses a significant obstacle to commercial use. In compression tests, Volkov found that cellulose aerogels crumbled under loads that conventional foam insulation routinely withstands, raising doubts about their practical durability in building applications.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 and the author of Text 2 would most likely agree on which of the following points?

- A: Cellulose aerogels should immediately replace petroleum-based insulation in all new construction projects.
- B: Cellulose aerogels can achieve thermal performance similar to that of conventional insulation.
- C: The mechanical fragility of cellulose aerogels is unlikely to pose a significant barrier to their commercial adoption.
- D: Laboratory testing alone is sufficient to determine whether a new insulation material is ready for widespread construction use.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Text 1 reports comparable thermal conductivity; Text 2 says "show promise" but raises a DIFFERENT concern (mechanical fragility, not thermal). Neither disputes thermal performance. Trick: for "would agree" questions, find the one claim neither author challenges. Eliminate options where one author explicitly disagrees.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 13

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Ecologist Sana Khoury has documented that artificial night lighting in coastal areas disorients sea turtle hatchlings, which rely on the natural luminance of the ocean horizon to navigate toward the sea. In heavily lit areas, hatchlings often crawl inland toward artificial light sources and perish from dehydration or predation.

Text 2

Conservation technologist Emeka Obi has developed amber-wavelength LED streetlights designed to reduce disorientation in sea turtle hatchlings. Obi's laboratory tests show that hatchlings exposed to amber light exhibit significantly less misdirected movement than those exposed to standard white LED light. Obi acknowledges, however, that field trials are needed to confirm these results under natural conditions.

Based on the texts, how would the author of Text 1 most likely view the technology described in Text 2?

- A: As a technology that addresses a different species of marine animal than the one discussed in Text 1.
- B: As a solution that has already been fully validated and is ready for immediate deployment along all affected coastlines.
- C: As likely to worsen the problem described in Text 1 by introducing a new type of artificial light into coastal habitats.
- D: As a potentially useful intervention for mitigating the problem identified in Text 1, pending confirmation in real-world settings.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Text 1 documents the problem (light disorients hatchlings); Text 2 offers a potential fix (amber LEDs reduce misdirection) with a caveat (field trials needed). The author of Text 1 would welcome a targeted solution while noting it's not yet proven outside the lab. Trick: when Text 2 offers a solution to Text 1's problem AND includes its own caveat, the correct answer almost always includes that caveat -- "pending confirmation" or "if verified."

END QUESTION

QUESTION 14

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Sociologist Rebecca Thorn contends that the rise of remote work has weakened what she calls 'ambient mentorship' -- the informal, unplanned learning that occurs when junior employees observe and interact with experienced colleagues in shared physical spaces. Without these spontaneous encounters, Thorn argues, professional development suffers.

Text 2

Organizational psychologist James Yoon reports that companies implementing structured virtual mentorship programs -- featuring regular one-on-one video sessions and collaborative online projects -- have seen mentee satisfaction rates comparable to those achieved through traditional in-person mentorship. Yoon suggests that deliberate program design can compensate for the loss of casual workplace interaction.

Based on the texts, how would Yoon (Text 2) most likely respond to Thorn's concern about remote work in Text 1?

- A: By suggesting that intentional virtual mentorship programs can replace the informal learning opportunities that remote work eliminates.
- B: By claiming that informal workplace interactions never contributed meaningfully to professional development in the first place.
- C: By arguing that remote workers develop stronger professional skills than in-person workers because they must be more self-directed.
- D: By presenting evidence that remote work has led to an overall increase in the total number of mentorship interactions between junior and senior employees.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Yoon offers a compensating mechanism (structured virtual programs achieve comparable satisfaction), not a denial that informal learning matters. Trick: compensation != denial. "Comparable satisfaction" means the gap CAN be filled, not that the gap never existed. Look for whether the response says "the problem doesn't exist" vs. "here's how to solve it."

END QUESTION

QUESTION 15

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Physicist Yara Hamdi has proposed that dark matter -- the invisible substance thought to constitute roughly 27% of the universe's mass-energy content -- may consist of primordial black holes formed in the moments after the Big Bang, rather than the exotic subatomic particles favored by most theoretical models.

Text 2

Astrophysicist Connor Blake notes that if primordial black holes accounted for all dark matter, their gravitational effects would produce observable distortions in the light of distant stars through a phenomenon called microlensing. Extensive surveys designed to detect such distortions have found far fewer microlensing events than the primordial black hole hypothesis predicts, suggesting that these objects can compose, at most, a small fraction of dark matter.

Based on the texts, how would Blake (Text 2) most likely evaluate Hamdi's proposal in Text 1?

- A: By claiming that Hamdi's proposal is based on a misunderstanding of the conditions that existed in the moments after the Big Bang.
- B: By agreeing that primordial black holes are the most promising candidate for dark matter, while noting that current detection methods need improvement to confirm this.
- C: By arguing that observational evidence suggests primordial black holes cannot account for all dark matter, as Hamdi proposes.
- D: By asserting that the microlensing phenomenon is too poorly understood to serve as a test for any dark matter hypothesis.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Blake's logic: if the hypothesis were true -> we'd see X microlensing events -> we see far fewer -> hypothesis fails at full scale. Prediction fails the observational test. Trick: Blake doesn't attack Hamdi's physics or dismiss the method -- he uses the method's results against the hypothesis. "Far fewer events than predicted" = the data don't support the claim.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 16

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Architect Simone Leclaire advocates for the widespread adoption of mass timber construction -- using engineered wood products such as cross-laminated timber (CLT) for the structural frames of mid-rise and tall buildings. Leclaire argues that mass timber sequesters atmospheric carbon, reduces construction waste, and is renewable, making it a more sustainable alternative to steel and concrete.

Text 2

Structural engineer Hassan Malek cautions that mass timber's fire performance remains a concern despite advances in fire-retardant treatments. Building codes in most countries still restrict timber-framed buildings to lower heights than steel or concrete structures, reflecting ongoing uncertainty about how mass timber behaves during prolonged, high-intensity fires.

Based on the texts, the author of Text 1 would most likely respond to the concern raised in Text 2 by making which of the following arguments?

- A: Fire-retardant treatments have already been proven to eliminate all meaningful fire risk in mass timber buildings, making Malek's concern outdated.
- B: The sustainability advantages of mass timber are significant enough to justify continued research into improving its fire performance.
- C: Steel and concrete structures present fire risks comparable to those of mass timber, making Malek's focus on timber unfairly selective.
- D: Building codes should be eliminated entirely to allow architects unrestricted freedom in selecting construction materials.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: An advocate's best response to a valid concern = acknowledge the concern + argue benefits justify further development. Leclaire can't claim fire risk is eliminated (Text 2 says "ongoing uncertainty") or that steel is equally risky (not her argument). Trick: when Text 1 is an advocate and Text 2 raises a real problem, the correct response is almost never "the problem doesn't exist" -- it's "the benefits outweigh and we should keep working on it."

END QUESTION



QUESTION 17

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Museums have traditionally displayed artifacts behind glass with minimal contextual information, an approach art historian Lucinda Vaz criticizes as 'decontextualized spectacle.' Vaz argues that without narrative context -- information about who made an object, how it was used, and what cultural values it embodied -- visitors engage with artifacts superficially, appreciating their aesthetic qualities while remaining ignorant of their historical significance.

Text 2

Curator Darian Cole maintains that too much contextual information can overwhelm visitors and diminish the aesthetic experience that draws people to museums in the first place. Cole advocates for a balanced approach in which a small number of carefully chosen details supplement, rather than replace, the visitor's direct encounter with the object.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between the positions of Vaz (Text 1) and Cole (Text 2)?

A: Vaz argues that artifacts should always be accompanied by extensive historical documentation, while Cole argues that artifacts should be displayed with no contextual information at all.

B: Both authors oppose the traditional museum approach and propose identical alternatives involving digital interactive displays.

C: Both authors are primarily concerned with increasing museum attendance, though they propose different strategies for achieving that goal.

D: Both advocate for providing context alongside artifacts, but they disagree about how much context is appropriate.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Vaz wants MORE context; Cole wants SOME context ("a small number of carefully chosen details"). Both agree context is needed -- the debate is how much. Trick: when two authors push in the same direction but to different degrees, the relationship is "agree on principle, differ on degree." Cole doesn't want zero context -- he wants less than Vaz.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 18

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: MEDIUM

PROMPT: Text 1

Epidemiologist Lucia Fonseca has shown that communities with higher rates of green space access -- parks, gardens, and tree-lined streets -- tend to report lower levels of chronic stress. Fonseca attributes this association to the restorative effects of natural environments, which have been shown to reduce cortisol levels and lower heart rate.

Text 2

Urban planner Derek Huang argues that the correlation between green space and reduced stress may be confounded by socioeconomic factors. Wealthier communities, Huang notes, tend to have both more green space and better access to healthcare, nutritious food, and safe housing -- all of which independently contribute to lower stress levels.

Based on the texts, how would Huang (Text 2) most likely respond to Fonseca's conclusion in Text 1?

- A: By disputing the scientific evidence that exposure to natural environments can reduce cortisol levels and lower heart rate.
- B: By arguing that communities should prioritize healthcare spending over green space investment, since healthcare produces larger stress reductions.
- C: By suggesting that Fonseca's conclusion may not adequately account for other variables associated with both green space access and stress levels.
- D: By claiming that lower-income communities actually have more green space than wealthier communities, undermining Fonseca's observed correlation.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Huang raises a confounding variable: wealth -> both green space AND better health. He doesn't dispute the cortisol evidence or make policy recommendations -- he questions whether the correlation proves what Fonseca thinks it proves. Trick: a confounding variable argument says "a third factor might drive BOTH X and Y." It doesn't deny the correlation exists; it challenges the causal interpretation.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 19

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Literary scholar Patricia Mendez argues that the unreliable narrator -- a storytelling device in which the narrator's account is revealed to be distorted by bias, ignorance, or deception -- functions primarily as a tool of psychological realism. By forcing readers to question the narrator's perspective, Mendez contends, the device mirrors the way people in real life must constantly evaluate the reliability of others' accounts.

Text 2

Narratologist Kwesi Appiah maintains that the unreliable narrator serves a fundamentally metafictional purpose: it foregrounds the constructed nature of all storytelling. When readers recognize a narrator's unreliability, Appiah argues, they become aware of the artifice inherent in narrative itself, prompting them to reflect not only on the narrator's biases but also on the conventions and assumptions that shape every act of narration.

Based on the texts, how would Appiah (Text 2) most likely respond to Mendez's characterization of the unreliable narrator in Text 1?

- A: By asserting that readers are generally unable to detect when a narrator is unreliable, which makes Mendez's analysis of the device's effects unfounded.
- B: By arguing that Mendez's emphasis on psychological realism understates the device's capacity to make readers critically aware of the nature of storytelling itself.
- C: By agreeing that psychological realism is the primary function of the unreliable narrator, while adding that the device also produces minor secondary effects on reader awareness.
- D: By claiming that Mendez has confused the unreliable narrator with a different literary technique that serves a distinct narrative purpose.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Appiah calls the metafictional purpose "fundamental" -- that's a disagreement about primary function, not an addition of a secondary one. Trick: "fundamental" and "primarily" are competing claims about what's MOST important. If Appiah merely agreed with Mendez and added a note, he'd say "also." Instead, he replaces Mendez's primary function with a different one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 20

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Climatologist Ingrid Solberg has proposed that stratospheric aerosol injection (SAI) -- a geoengineering technique that would involve dispersing reflective particles in the upper atmosphere to reduce incoming solar radiation -- could serve as a temporary measure to slow global warming while long-term decarbonization efforts proceed. Solberg emphasizes that SAI would not address the root cause of climate change but could buy critical time.

Text 2

Environmental ethicist Kwame Mensah objects that SAI creates a 'moral hazard': by offering the appearance of a quick fix, it may reduce political urgency to cut greenhouse gas emissions. Furthermore, Mensah warns, if SAI were ever abruptly halted -- due to geopolitical conflict or technical failure -- the suppressed warming would return rapidly, potentially causing more severe climate disruption than would have occurred without the intervention.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes how Mensah's argument in Text 2 relates to Solberg's proposal in Text 1?

- A: Mensah raises both a political and a physical risk that he believes undermine the viability of the approach Solberg advocates.
- B: Mensah disputes Solberg's claim that SAI would effectively reduce the amount of solar radiation reaching Earth's surface.
- C: Mensah supports the use of SAI as a temporary measure but argues that its implementation should be delayed until international regulatory agreements are in place.
- D: Mensah and Solberg disagree about whether greenhouse gas emissions are the primary driver of global warming.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Mensah raises two distinct risks: moral hazard (political -- reduced urgency to cut emissions) and termination shock (physical -- rapid rebound warming). Both target Solberg's "temporary measure" framing. Trick: count the objections. When an author raises two different types of concerns (one political, one physical), the correct answer should capture BOTH, not just one.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 21

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Philosopher Dara Okonjo has argued that artificial intelligence systems should not be described as 'creative,' even when they produce novel outputs such as paintings or musical compositions. True creativity, Okonjo contends, requires intentionality -- the capacity to envision a goal and pursue it through deliberate choices -- and current AI systems lack this capacity, operating instead through sophisticated pattern recognition on training data.

Text 2

Computational artist Felix Brandt counters that defining creativity in terms of intentionality privileges a narrowly human conception of the creative process. Brandt points out that many human creative breakthroughs arise not from deliberate planning but from accidental combinations and unconscious associations -- processes that, he argues, are functionally analogous to the stochastic recombination of patterns that characterizes AI-generated art.

Based on the texts, which choice best characterizes the core disagreement between Okonjo (Text 1) and Brandt (Text 2)?

- A: They disagree about whether AI systems can produce outputs that human observers would describe as novel or aesthetically interesting.
- B: They disagree about whether human creative processes ever involve unconscious or accidental elements.
- C: They disagree about whether AI-generated artwork should be eligible for prizes in competitions designed for human artists.
- D: They disagree about whether intentionality is a necessary component of creativity.

ANSWER: D

EXPLANATION: Okonjo: creativity requires intentionality (necessary condition). Brandt: that definition is too narrow -- accidental/unconscious processes count too. Trick: identify the necessary condition being disputed. Both agree AI produces novel outputs -- the question is whether novelty alone = creativity, or whether intentionality is also required.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 22

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Ecologist Mariana Costa has proposed the 'landscape of fear' hypothesis, which holds that the mere presence of predators in an ecosystem shapes prey behavior in ways that have cascading effects on vegetation. Prey animals that perceive predation risk, Costa argues, avoid certain areas, allowing plants in those areas to recover from overgrazing.

Text 2

Ecologist Jakob Lindqvist tested the landscape of fear hypothesis in a grassland ecosystem from which wolves had been absent for thirty years and were recently reintroduced. Contrary to the hypothesis's predictions, Lindqvist found no significant difference in elk grazing patterns or vegetation density between areas with high and low wolf activity. He attributes this result to the possibility that elk in this ecosystem had lost their antipredator behavioral responses during the long period without wolves and had not yet re-developed them.

Based on the texts, how would Costa (Text 1) most likely respond to Lindqvist's findings in Text 2?

A: By claiming that Lindqvist's study used an inadequate sample size of elk, making the results statistically unreliable.

B: By conceding that the landscape of fear hypothesis has been definitively refuted and proposing an alternative ecological model in its place.

C: By arguing that the absence of the predicted behavioral changes does not refute the hypothesis, since the elk population studied may not have had sufficient time to reestablish antipredator responses.

D: By asserting that wolves are not effective apex predators in grassland environments, so the hypothesis's predictions would not apply to Lindqvist's study site.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Lindqvist's own explanation (elk lost antipredator responses during 30 wolf-free years) actually supports Costa's defense -- the hypothesis isn't wrong, the elk just haven't readapted. Trick: when Text 2 offers a negative result PLUS an alternative explanation, check whether that explanation can be turned into a defense of Text 1's hypothesis. Here, "haven't re-developed responses" = "give it more time."

END QUESTION

QUESTION 23

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Sociologist Petra Lang has documented a pattern she calls 'credential inflation,' in which occupations that previously required only a high school diploma now demand a bachelor's degree, even when the actual skills needed for the job have not changed. Lang argues that this trend disadvantages workers from lower socioeconomic backgrounds who face financial barriers to higher education.

Text 2

Labor economist Raj Chaturvedi acknowledges that credential requirements have risen but argues that this reflects genuine changes in workplace demands. As industries adopt more complex technologies, Chaturvedi contends, workers need the analytical and communication skills that higher education cultivates -- skills that may not be apparent from a job description alone but are nonetheless essential for effective performance.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the fundamental difference between Lang's and Chaturvedi's interpretations of rising credential requirements?

A: Lang views the trend as a gatekeeping mechanism unrelated to actual job demands, while Chaturvedi views it as a reasonable response to genuinely increased skill requirements.

B: Lang argues that credential requirements have risen in all industries without exception, while Chaturvedi argues that the increase has occurred only in technology-related occupations.

C: Lang attributes rising credential requirements primarily to government regulation of hiring practices, while Chaturvedi attributes them to employers' independent decisions.

D: Lang focuses on how the trend increases employers' recruitment costs, while Chaturvedi focuses on how it affects workers' long-term career prospects.

ANSWER: A

EXPLANATION: Same trend, opposite interpretations: Lang says artificial barrier (skills haven't changed), Chaturvedi says genuine need (workplace demands have changed). Trick: when both authors acknowledge the same phenomenon but explain it differently, the correct answer captures the interpretive split -- "gatekeeping vs. justified response" -- not a difference in scope or evidence type.

END QUESTION

QUESTION 24

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

In a 2022 study, psychologist Elena Varga found that participants who were asked to recall a past act of generosity subsequently reported higher levels of life satisfaction than participants in a control group. Varga interpreted this finding as evidence that reflecting on prosocial behavior activates a positive self-concept, which in turn elevates subjective well-being.

Text 2

Psychologist Andre Muller replicated Varga's protocol but added physiological measures of emotional arousal. While Muller confirmed that participants who recalled generous acts reported higher satisfaction, he found no corresponding increase in physiological arousal (measured by skin conductance and heart rate). Muller suggests that the self-reported satisfaction increase may reflect social desirability bias -- participants reporting what they believe the researchers expect -- rather than a genuine shift in well-being.

Based on the texts, how would Muller (Text 2) most likely characterize Varga's interpretation of her findings in Text 1?

- A: As fully supported by Muller's data, which replicated both the self-reported satisfaction increase and the expected physiological changes.
- B: As potentially reflecting participants' desire to appear consistent with social expectations rather than capturing an actual change in well-being.
- C: As based on a research design that Muller considers fundamentally flawed due to its reliance on a control group rather than a within-subjects approach.
- D: As irrelevant to the broader question of whether prosocial behavior affects psychological outcomes in any meaningful way.

ANSWER: B

EXPLANATION: Muller confirmed the self-report result BUT found no physiological change to back it up. The gap between what participants say and what their bodies show = possible social desirability bias. Trick: "confirmed X but not Y" != "fully supported." When one measure confirms and another contradicts, the interpretation is qualified, not validated. The missing physiological evidence is the key.

END QUESTION



QUESTION 25

SECTION: READING\_WRITING

CATEGORY: SAT Practice: Cross-Text Connections

DIFFICULTY: HARD

PROMPT: Text 1

Linguist Sofia Herrera argues that the global spread of English as a lingua franca is enriching, not impoverishing, the world's linguistic landscape. As speakers in different regions adapt English to local phonological and grammatical patterns, Herrera contends, they create new varieties -- such as Singlish and Nigerian Pidgin -- that function as distinct linguistic systems worthy of scholarly study.

Text 2

Sociolinguist Kofi Adjei counters that the proliferation of English varieties cannot compensate for the loss of indigenous languages that occurs when communities shift to English for economic advancement. Adjei points out that approximately one language goes extinct every two weeks, and that the social prestige of English accelerates this process by discouraging younger generations from learning their ancestral languages.

Based on the texts, which choice best describes the relationship between Herrera's argument (Text 1) and Adjei's argument (Text 2)?

- A: Herrera argues that English's global spread has had no negative consequences for any existing language, while Adjei argues that English should be actively suppressed to protect indigenous languages.
- B: Both authors agree that the global spread of English is creating new linguistic varieties, but they disagree about whether those varieties should be considered legitimate languages.
- C: Herrera focuses on the new linguistic diversity created by English's spread, while Adjei focuses on the existing linguistic diversity that English's spread threatens to eliminate.
- D: Adjei provides historical data that directly disproves Herrera's claim that varieties like Singlish and Nigerian Pidgin function as distinct linguistic systems.

ANSWER: C

EXPLANATION: Same phenomenon (English spreading), different focus: Herrera sees creation of new diversity; Adjei sees destruction of existing diversity. Trick: Adjei doesn't deny new varieties exist -- he says they don't compensate for what's being lost. When two authors look at the same trend and emphasize opposite effects, the relationship is "different focus," not "direct contradiction."

END QUESTION